CPBYTE

InHacks 2026

Participant Handbook & Guidelines

1. Introduction

The CPBYTE Internal Hackathon is an opportunity for club members to experience the complete product development cycle - from identifying a real-world problem, to building a working solution, and finally presenting it before a judging panel.

This hackathon is designed to encourage innovation, teamwork, technical learning, and problem-solving while providing participants with a friendly and supportive environment to explore new technologies and domains.

Whether this is your first hackathon or you already have development experience, this event is an opportunity to learn, collaborate, build, and grow within the CPBYTE community.

2. Why Should You Participate?

As students entering their second year, this is the ideal time to start participating in hackathons and project-based learning. Benefits of participating include:

- Gain practical, hands-on development experience
- Learn how to transform ideas into real, working products
- Work alongside teammates from different technical domains
- Improve communication, teamwork, and presentation skills
- Build projects that can strengthen your portfolio and resume
- Receive guidance and feedback from senior mentors
- Get exposure to real-world problem solving
- Compete for exciting rewards, recognition, and certificates
- Showcase your skills and potential within the club

Most importantly, this hackathon is designed to provide a supportive environment where participants can learn while building something meaningful.

3. Hackathon Format

This is an Open Innovation Hackathon. Participants are expected to:

- Identify a real-world problem
- Research and validate the problem
- Design an innovative solution
- Build a working application or platform
- Present and demonstrate their solution

Teams are encouraged to work on ideas that combine multiple domains rather than focusing on a single area. Examples include:

- AI + Web Development
- Cybersecurity + AI
- Web Development + Data Analytics
- AI + Cloud Computing

Interdisciplinary projects are strongly encouraged.

4. Eligibility Criteria

To participate in the hackathon, the following conditions must be met:

- Each team must consist of exactly 3 members
- A minimum of 2 members must be from CPBYTE Club
- The third member may be a CPBYTE member, or a student from the same institute and same academic year
- All team members must satisfy the eligibility requirements at the time of registration

5. Team Formation Guidelines

Each team must contain exactly 3 members. Participants are encouraged to form teams with members having different skill sets and technical interests, such as:

- Development
- Artificial Intelligence
- Cybersecurity
- UI/UX Design
- Cloud & DevOps
- Data Analytics

Diverse teams often perform better because responsibilities can be distributed efficiently across different domains.

6. Mentor Allocation

Each team will be assigned one dedicated mentor. The mentor selection process works as follows:

- Teams must provide mentor preferences during registration
- Multiple mentor preferences will be collected via the registration form
- Mentor allocation will depend on: preference submitted, mentor availability, registration order, and mentor decision (if applicable)

Important Notes

- Mentor allocation is not guaranteed based solely on the first preference
- Each mentor can guide only one team
- Teams should provide multiple preferences to ensure smooth allocation
- The mentor's role is to guide teams throughout the hackathon and help them stay on track

7. Registration Process

To register, each team must submit the following details via the official registration form:

- Team Name
- Team Members Details
- Mentor Preferences
- Other Required Details

Registration Deadline	10 June 2026

Only complete registrations submitted before the deadline will be considered. Late or incomplete submissions will not be accepted.

8. Timeline

Registration Phase

Deadline	10 June 2026

Round 1 – Idea & Presentation Round (Online)

Dates	28 June – 30 June 2026

This is the first evaluation round where teams present their idea and initial direction. Teams must submit:

- Project Presentation (PPT) - required
- Working Prototype - if available
- GitHub Repository - if available

Round 1 focuses on: problem identification, clarity of idea, innovation, proposed approach, and overall vision of the project.

Round 2 – MVP Evaluation Round (Online)

Dates	15 July – 17 July 2026

In this round, teams are expected to have built and demonstrate a working MVP (Minimum Viable Product). Teams must submit and present:

- Working MVP - required
- Project Presentation (PPT) - updated from Round 1
- GitHub Repository containing all project work - required

During the evaluation meeting, teams must:

- Demonstrate their MVP live
- Explain the technical implementation and decisions made
- Answer questions from judges and mentors
- Show progress made since Round 1

Round 2 focuses on: technical implementation, MVP functionality, progress since Round 1, and understanding of the project.

Note: Only the teams shortlisted after Round 2 evaluation will advance to the Final Round.

Round 3 – Final Round (Offline)

Month	August 2026

Teams must present a fully completed project, a refined solution, demonstrated functionality, and improved implementation based on feedback received during Round 2. This round will be conducted offline.

9. Round 1 Submission Requirements

For Round 1 (Idea & Presentation Round), teams must submit:

- Project Presentation (PPT) - required
- Working Prototype - if available
- GitHub Repository Link - if available

During the evaluation meeting, teams must:

- Attend the evaluation meeting
- Present their idea and planned approach
- Answer questions from judges and mentors
- Recorded demos may be requested later if required

10. Round 2 Submission Requirements

For Round 2 (MVP Evaluation Round), teams must submit all of the following:

- Working MVP / Prototype - required
- Project Presentation (PPT) - updated
- GitHub Repository Link - required

Additionally, during the evaluation meeting:

- Teams must attend the evaluation meeting
- Teams must demonstrate their MVP live
- Teams must explain the technical implementation
- Teams must answer questions from judges and mentors
- Recorded demos may be requested later if required

11. Final Round Requirements

For the Final Round, teams should be prepared with:

- Fully functional application or platform
- Complete implementation of core features
- Proper project architecture
- Clean and understandable codebase
- Project presentation
- Live demonstration

The final solution should reflect significant progress beyond the Round 2 MVP.

12. Judging Criteria

Projects will be evaluated on multiple factors. Below is an overview of the key evaluation areas:

Criteria	What We Look For
Innovation & Creativity	Originality of the idea, problem relevance, novel approach to solving the problem
Technical Implementation	Quality of development, technical complexity, system design and architecture
Understanding of the Project	Ability to explain implementation details, understanding of technologies and workflow
Problem-Solving Ability	Clarity of the identified problem, effectiveness of the proposed solution
Project Completeness	Functionality of the solution, feature implementation, product readiness
Presentation & Communication	Quality of pitching, demonstration effectiveness, ability to answer questions confidently
Team Collaboration	Contribution of all team members, coordination and teamwork

13. Use of AI Tools

The use of AI tools such as ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Claude, Gemini, and similar platforms is permitted. However, the following conditions apply:

- Participants must understand the code they submit
- Participants should be able to explain all implementation details
- Blindly generated code without understanding is strongly discouraged
- Judges may ask technical questions regarding any part of the project

The objective is to build and learn - not simply to generate code.

14. Project Guidelines

Participants may use open-source libraries, public frameworks, third-party APIs, and standard development tools and platforms. However:

- The project should not rely entirely on third-party services
- Teams must contribute significant original work
- Participants should demonstrate clear ownership and understanding of the project
- Previously started ideas may be considered only if substantial innovation, improvement, and original contribution are demonstrated during the hackathon period

15. Team Change Policy

Any request regarding member replacement, team restructuring, team withdrawal, or other exceptional circumstances must be reported to the Hackathon Leads and the assigned Mentor.

The final decision regarding team modifications will be taken by the Hackathon Organizing Team. Unauthorized team changes may result in penalties or disqualification.

16. Academic Integrity & Plagiarism Policy

All submissions must represent genuine effort from the participating team. The following are strictly prohibited:

- Copying another team's work
- Submitting projects created entirely by others
- Presenting code without understanding it
- Misrepresentation of contributions
- Any form of academic dishonesty

Projects may be reviewed for originality and authenticity. Violation of these guidelines may result in immediate disqualification, removal from the hackathon, and further disciplinary action within the club if deemed necessary.

17. Code of Conduct

All participants are expected to:

- Maintain professionalism throughout the event
- Respect fellow participants, mentors, and organizers
- Communicate respectfully at all times
- Follow instructions issued by the organizing team
- Maintain ethical behavior throughout the event

Any misconduct or disruptive behavior will not be tolerated. The organizing team reserves the right to take appropriate action when necessary.

18. Certificates, Rewards & Recognition

All eligible participants who successfully participate in the hackathon will receive certificates. In addition, participants will have opportunities to:

- Showcase their skills and projects
- Gain recognition within the club
- Learn from mentors and peers
- Build strong portfolio projects
- Demonstrate leadership, technical, and teamwork abilities

Top-performing teams may receive:

- Winner and Runner-Up Certificates
- Exclusive Merchandise
- Goodies and Swags
- Gift Vouchers
- Priority Opportunities in Future Club Activities
- Special Recognition within CPBYTE
- Other Exciting Rewards and Benefits

19. Communication & Support

For any queries, announcements, or support:

- Use the official CPBYTE communication channels
- Contact your assigned mentor
- Follow updates shared by the organizing team

A dedicated hackathon communication group will also be created to ensure smooth coordination and timely updates.

20. Final Note

The objective of this hackathon is not only to build projects but also to learn, collaborate, and prepare for future technical opportunities.

Take initiative, experiment with new ideas, work with your teammates, learn from your mentor, and make the most of the experience.

Build something meaningful. Learn something new. Enjoy the process.